

KNOW WHICH ONE YOU'RE USING

Little AI vs. Big AI

Two kinds of AI, and one difference that decides who is accountable for the output.

TYPE A

Little AI

Rules-based and deterministic

- Follows predefined rules and conditions
- Produces predictable, repeatable results

SAME INPUT

Same output, every time

EXAMPLES

- A phone tree routing calls by the button pressed
- A Power Automate flow triggering actions on conditions

TYPE B

Big AI

Generative and probabilistic

- Produces output from learned patterns, not fixed rules
- Handles ambiguous or open-ended requests

SAME INPUT

Potentially a different output

EXAMPLES

- Claude answering a question in natural language
- An AI synthesizing documents into a first draft

WHY IT MATTERS

Little AI executes decisions already encoded in the system. Big AI generates new output — so people must judge, verify, and remain accountable for it.



AI IMPLEMENTATION IN REGULATED ENVIRONMENTS